

NeoGenCode Technologies Full Stack Developer - What to Learn

MUST Learn (Class A keywords with no direct project experience)

- **Next.js rendering strategies (SSR, SSG, ISR)** – you use Next.js daily (Echo, Vibe, Clink AI) but mostly with client-side/default rendering; this JD specifically wants hands-on SSR (server-side render per request), SSG (build-time static generation), and ISR (incremental static regeneration – static pages that revalidate on a schedule). Read the Next.js App Router docs on **fetch** cache options and **revalidate**, then convert one existing page in a side project to each strategy to see the difference in Network tab behavior.
- **Laravel (PHP framework)** – you have real production PHP experience from ITJOBXS, but raw PHP, not Laravel’s MVC structure (routing, Eloquent ORM, Blade templates, middleware). Bridge from Express.js: Laravel routes $\approx$ Express routes, Eloquent models $\approx$ Prisma/Mongoose models. Build one small CRUD app with Laravel + Eloquent to see the parallels directly.

GOOD to Learn (strengthens the application, not blocking)

- **JWT/OAuth implemented directly (not via Clerk)** – you have real auth experience, but always through Clerk’s managed service. This JD’s “preferred” JWT/OAuth likely means implementing token issuance/verification yourself. Skim a minimal JWT auth flow in Express or Next.js API routes (sign, verify, refresh) to be able to speak to it without a third-party abstraction.
- **Vercel deployment specifics** – you deploy to Vercel already (all your projects), so this is mostly about knowing Vercel’s Next.js-specific features (Edge Functions, ISR on Vercel’s infrastructure, preview deployments) well enough to discuss deployment trade-offs in an interview.

Fast-Ramp Note

This is a strong match overall – React.js, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, and Git are all genuine, and your ITJOBXS internship gives you real production PHP/MySQL experience most React-focused candidates won’t have. The two gaps worth closing before an interview are Next.js’s specific rendering strategies (SSR/SSG/ISR) – since the JD calls these out explicitly as a responsibility, not just a skill – and Laravel as the PHP framework layer on top of your existing raw-PHP experience.